SACRAMENT MEETING TALK · 5–8 MIN

Integrity and Virtue Lead to Happiness

Elder Quentin L. Cook · October 2026 general conference

1. TALK OVERVIEW

Elder Quentin L. Cook of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles spoke about integrity, virtue and happiness. As a new missionary, President David O. McKay passed a building with a stone above the doorway inscribed “What e’er thou art, act well thy part.” In Heavenly Father’s plan, integrity, virtue and happiness are intrinsically linked — true happiness is the outcome of integrity and virtue. That relationship is less well understood today; the founders of the United States emphasized life, liberty and happiness based on living a virtuous life. The Lord wants us to experience the joy of a virtuous life and richly rewards those who make sacrifices in His name. Covenant keepers are expected to live lives of virtue and integrity; the ultimate reward is the constant companionship of the Holy Ghost. Part of integrity is acknowledging faults to the Lord and repenting. When repentance is a constant day-to-day part of our lives, we can approach the Lord with integrity and receive His saving blessings. Integrity, virtue and ongoing repentance are the answer to today’s challenges.

Summary written for this site; read the official text for the full message.

2. OPEN

Open with a brief personal experience related to the message, then introduce: Where do I need more integrity and virtue so the Holy Ghost can be my constant companion?

3. KEY QUOTES

> *“The virtuous, Christlike life necessary to sustain us and propel us along the covenant path has never been more important or challenging.”*

> *“In the Father’s plan, integrity, virtue, and happiness are intrinsically linked.”*

4. SCRIPTURES CITED

- Matthew 7:13–14
- Doctrine and Covenants 124:20
- Matthew 5:3–11
- 3 Nephi 12:1–11
- Doctrine and Covenants 121:45

5. ACTIVITY

Teach the message using one scripture and one quote, adding your own testimony and experience.

6. SUGGESTED INVITATION

Live with integrity and virtue; make repentance a constant day-to-day part of your life. Close by extending the invitation and bearing testimony of Jesus Christ.